

LEVEL 2: PISTA

Game Design Document — refined pass, revision 3

Legend: black = original design, unchanged · blue = added detail · green = decision made this round · red = still open

LEVEL SUMMARY

- Goal: recover the scraps of the Pista painting, assemble them, and open the way to the next level (Dagat).
- Beat order: Restrictions armed → Problem 1 (kandila) → Scene 2 (church) → Problem 2 (Alley 1, birds) → Problem 3 (Alley 2, bandaritas) → Scene 3 (assembly) → Dagat.
- Setting: town plaza during the fiesta — church, huts, bandaritas, dancers, crowd. Plaza assets exist (BG_Sky, BG_Clouds, MG_Church, MG_People, FG_Huts, Ground, TextureMap_Piyesta).
- Persistent flags this level reads or writes:
 - L1_PROTECTOR_PATH (read from Level 1) → controls the crease.
 - L1_MADE_KEY (read from Level 1) → controls the Problem 1 Path C dialogue.
 - HAS_FLOWER → written only by Problem 1 Path A cleared within two attempts. Gates a secret ending, so it outlives this level.
 - DANCERS_GONE → set by Problem 1 Path B. The dancers do not come back to the plaza.
 - BIRDS_IN_ALLEY2 → an integer, not a boolean. It is the number of birds that reached the bandaritas.
 - BANDARITAS_CUT → set by the scissors route in Problem 3; every later scene uses the no-bandarita art variants.
- Scrap economy: seven scraps in total — five carried by the birds in Alley 1, two in the bandaritas in Alley 2. None can be permanently lost; a missed bird only defers its scrap to the next screen.
- Checkpoints: level start, after Problem 1, after Scene 2, after Problem 2. A restriction violation returns the player to the nearest one behind them.

CONSEQUENCE:

- If level 1 they choose the protector path to find the painting = there will be a visible crease on the painting's background: example: (gemini generated, maybe make crease assets)



- If not then no changes

Added detail

- Build the crease as a transparent PNG overlay laid on top of Level2_CompletedLook, not as a second full painting — one painting, one overlay, toggled by the flag.
- The crease is cosmetic. It does not change the scrap count, the paths available, or the ending of the level.
- It should be visible in Scene 3 when the painting is assembled, and again wherever the painting is shown afterwards.

RESTRICTIONS:

- Not allowed to FLY = bandaritas = will go back to previous checkpoint if flying above a certain height
- Not allowed to be SMALL INSECTS = so many people will be walking around and occasional parade float? (need asset for this) = will go back to previous checkpoint
- Dialogue: something about being careful/lolo laughing making fun of apo

Flight ceiling — decided

- The ceiling is the bandarita line itself, set per scene rather than as one global number. Whatever Y the bandaritas are strung at in a given scene, the ceiling sits just under it.
- This makes the rule diegetic: the player is not stopped by an invisible wall, they are stopped by the strings that are visibly in the way. The warning band should be drawn at the bandarita line so the boundary is the art, not a HUD element.
- The flying classes this actually constrains are bird, bat, butterfly and bee. Nothing else in the vocabulary flies. Hot air balloon and parachute are drawable objects, not playable actors, so they are outside this rule unless the player can ride them.
- Decided: once BANDARITAS_CUT is true, the ceiling lifts. There are no strings left to stop the player, so flying becomes legal from that point on.
- This turns the cut into a genuine trade rather than a free choice — climbing preserves the town, cutting buys the player the sky. It also means the restriction was never an arbitrary rule: it was an obstacle the player was always able to remove.
- Within Level 2 the reward has a short runway — the cut happens in Alley 2 and Scene 3 is a static assembly screen. The payoff is mostly in whether BANDARITAS_CUT carries into later

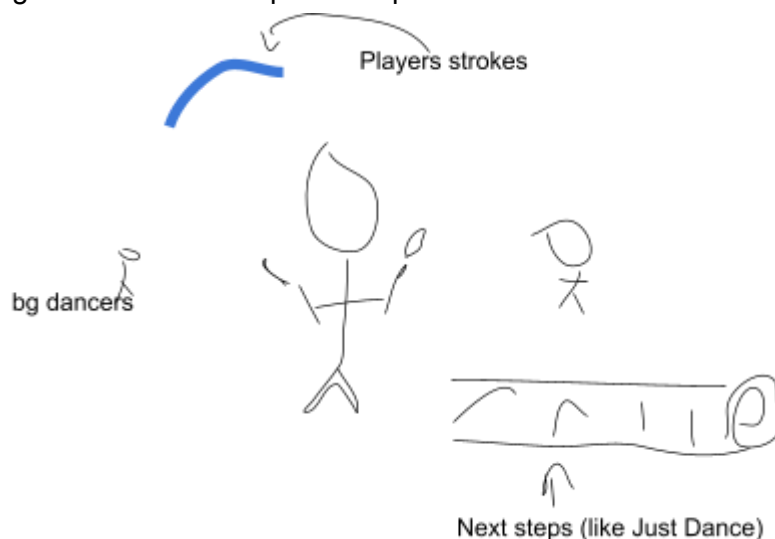
levels. Worth giving the player one moment of open air in Alley 2 after the cut so the reward registers at all.

Small animals — decided

- Banned as playable actors for the whole of Level 2, six classes: ant, bee, butterfly, spider, scorpion, snail.
- Why these six: each is small enough to be trampled by the crowd or the parade float, which is the fiction the restriction rests on. All six are also expendable — no Level 2 puzzle needs any of them.
- Deliberately not banned: frog and monkey, because both are named in Problem 1 Path B as ways to scare the dancers; banning them would break a stated path. Crab is borderline on size but is left legal for the same reason — nothing needs it banned, and a shorter list is easier to explain to the player.
- Note the two restrictions do not overlap much: bird and bat are stopped by the ceiling, ant, spider, scorpion and snail by the size rule, and butterfly and bee are caught by both. That is fine, but the size rule should be checked first so the player gets the more specific message.
- Write both rules as explicit class lists in the level config, checked against labels.json. Never infer size or flight from the label at runtime.

PROBLEM 1:

- Need a KANDILA (candle)
 - Path A: ask dancers for kandila
 - They ask you to dance for them
 - Dancing game mode (like the Halloween google game) in which you time the drawing right to the dance steps. Example:



- Given a flower for the performance
- Lore: got married here? Idk yet
- Go to scene 2
- Path B: scare the dancers
 - Turn into a snake or something that will scare the dancers (frog, monkey, shark, idk)
 - Get the candle
 - Go to scene 2

- Path C: find a candle
 - Walk around the houses and find a door with lights inside
 - Create a key that imitates the lock
 - If already created a key before (chose path B in entering the house level 1) = Dialogue would be about lolo saying theyve done this before
 - If they chose to find the key (path A) or the path C = dialogue would guide
 - Get inside the house and find a candle
 - Go to scene 2

Path A — dance minigame

- Fail rule, decided: the player gets two attempts. Clear it in one or two, and the dancers give the kandila and the flower. Fail both, and they give the kandila anyway and withhold the flower.
- This means the level itself is unloseable — the kandila is never withheld and the run never dead-ends. Only the flower is at stake.
- Three routes lose it: Path B, Path C, or Path A failed twice. That the loss is silent is the point — a secret ending that announces its own requirements is not secret. No in-level tell is needed.
- What this does mean is that the flower has to be visible in inventory once earned, and it has to survive to the end of the game. Its acquisition here is the only place it can be picked up, so the flag needs to be part of the persistent save from this level onward, not level-scoped state.
- The dance minigame is the one screen in this level that is not free drawing. It needs its own input mode: a cue appears, the player draws the shape, the timing of the completed stroke is scored.
- Between the first and second attempt, lolo should tease rather than instruct — it is the same register as the restriction dialogue.

Path B — scare the dancers

- Decided: the dancers are gone from the plaza permanently once scared. They do not return.
- Art consequence: MG_People currently has the dancers painted into it. They have to come out of that composite and become their own sprites regardless, and MG_People needs a no-dancers variant for every scene after the scare.
- Narrative consequence worth using: the plaza is lolo's memory, and the player has just emptied it. A quiet line from him afterwards costs nothing and makes the choice land.
- Path A closes the moment the dancers scatter. Signal the irreversibility before the player commits.
- Accepted scare classes, from the vocabulary: snake, monkey, shark, frog. All four are in the creature list. Define the set explicitly — do not let any large creature pass.

Path C — key

- Reuses the lock-imitation mechanic from Level 1. Shared code, shared lock art, not a rebuild.
- key and door are both in the vocabulary, so this path is fully supported by the current classifier.
- Put the lit house past two or three dark doors so the search reads as a search.

SCENE 2:

- inside the church they place the candle and lolo seems like he's praying. A priest approaches them and tells them that Lola was here a while ago, praying. Last she was seen walking around the dark alleys. (or something)

Added detail

- This is an interior scene. MG_Church is an exterior facade only — the church interior is a whole background set that does not exist yet.
- Beat order inside: place the kandila on the altar → lolo prays (he is a spirit, so this should read as a quiet, uncharacteristic moment) → priest approaches → he names the alleys → exit to Alley 1.
- This is a checkpoint, and the only place in the level where the pace drops. Let it breathe before the alley sequence.
- The priest's line is the only signpost for the second half of the level. Make it name the alleys clearly.

PROBLEM 2: Alley 1

- Birds have scraps of painting in their beaks
- Path A: calm the birds by drawing bread (replace the mushroom in the conceptnet table to bread)
 - Lore: they used to feed the birds all the time
 - Move to alley 2
- Path B: chase the birds
 - They get caught up in the bandaritas which is connected to problem 3
 - Move to alley 2
- Path C: hit the birds
 - Boomerang/stone aim to the birds (angry birds style)
 - Move to alley 2

Bird count and timer — decided

- Five birds, one painting scrap each.
- Path C runs on a timer of 45 to 60 seconds. Birds brought down inside the timer drop their scrap where the player can collect it. Any bird still airborne when the timer expires flies off and tangles in the bandaritas in Alley 2, carrying its scrap with it.
- This makes the outcome per-bird rather than pass or fail: a player who downs three of five walks into Alley 2 with two birds waiting. Nothing is ever lost, only deferred to the next screen — which is what keeps a timer from feeling punitive.
- Path B sends all five to the bandaritas at once. So BIRDS_IN_ALLEY2 is a count from zero to five, written by both Path B (always five) and Path C (however many escaped), and left at zero by Path A.
- Lolo's line when birds escape: “maybe they flew nearby, come on” — placeholder wording, keeps the failure moving forward instead of dwelling on it.
- Path A calms all five with one bread. Splitting it into one bread per bird would turn a lore beat into a chore.

- Show the timer as something in the fiction — the birds circling higher, the light changing — rather than a bare countdown, if it can be read at a glance.

Vocabulary check on this problem

- bread now replaces mushroom in the object list. The vocabulary stays at 50 classes — 27 objects, one swapped, none added.
- The swap still has to ship as one versioned set: model.onnx, labels.json and entities.json exported together. If label order drifts between them, every prediction in the game silently mistranslates and nothing crashes to tell you.
- boomerang is in the object list, so Path C works. There is no stone class. Recommend dropping “stone” from the design wording rather than adding a class for it — boomerang alone carries the mechanic, and circle would read as a stone only by accident.

bread is used for...

en eating →
 en sandwiches →
 en baking →
 en buttering →
 en consumption →
 en drying to make stuffing →
 en Feeding to the birds →

ConceptNet 5.8 — bread. UsedFor includes feeding to the birds, which is the assertion Path A rests on.

PROBLEM 3: Alley 2: only 2 choices for this one (deliberate)

- The last needed scraps are in the bandaritas
- IF: they chose Path B: the birds will be there too
- Path A: make ladders towards the bandaritas
 - Make ladders/climb something = get painting (if with birds also get those)
 - Go to scene 3
- Path B and Path C: cut the bandaritas using scissors
 - No visible bandaritas will be seen for the rest of the scenes
 - Go to scene 3

Free choice — confirmed

- Climbing and cutting are a free choice. What happened in Problem 2 does not decide it — it only decides whether there are birds up there to free as well.
- Rename the two options to 3A (climb) and 3B (cut) in the source document. As written they read as Path A / Path B / Path C, which collides with the Problem 2 labels and makes the branch look forced.
- Both routes recover every remaining scrap, including any carried by tangled birds. Neither route can lose a scrap.
- ladder, stairs and scissors are all in the object vocabulary, so both routes are supported. “Climb something” can legitimately accept either ladder or stairs.
- Cutting has a real art cost: bandaritas are painted into BG_Clouds and FG_Huts, so a no-bandarita variant of both is needed and the bandaritas must be lifted into their own layer.
- Cutting is the one player action in this level that permanently changes the town. Worth a beat of reaction from lolo.
- Decided: two scraps in the bandaritas, independent of the birds. With the five from Alley 1 that puts the painting at seven pieces.
- Seven is a good number for the Scene 3 layout — enough that assembly reads as a real reconstruction, few enough that it stays a light interaction rather than a jigsaw.

- Cut the seven scrap shapes from Level2_CompletedLook along irregular tear lines, not a grid. If two of them are the pieces that were strung up in the bandaritas, they can carry a slightly different weathering.

SCENE 3:

- Assemble the paintings and find the next level: Dagat

Added detail

- The assembled painting is Level2_CompletedLook, with the crease overlay on top if the flag is set.
- Seven scraps into seven slots, drag with a snap. Keep it a light interaction, not a puzzle with a fail state at the end of the level.
- The transition to Dagat has an asset already waiting: bangka.png. Ending the level on the boat is the cleanest hook.

END

CLASS VOCABULARY USED IN THIS LEVEL

Reference: 50 classes — 20 creatures (playable actors), 3 primitives, 27 objects (drawable objects). Per-class relations are in the attribution table, Appendix C.

Classes Level 2 depends on

- Problem 1 Path B (scare): snake, monkey, shark, frog.
- Problem 1 Path C (key): key, door.
- Problem 2 Path A (feed): bread — now in the vocabulary, swapped in for mushroom.
- Problem 2 Path C (hit): boomerang. No stone class exists; drop the stone wording.
- Problem 3 (climb or cut): ladder, stairs, scissors.

Classes banned in Level 2

- Small animals, cannot be spawned as playable actors anywhere in the level: ant, bee, butterfly, spider, scorpion, snail.
- Flight-capped at the bandarita line rather than banned: bird, bat, butterfly, bee.
- Both lists live in the level config and are validated against labels.json at load. A class named in either list that is missing from labels.json should fail loudly at startup, not silently at runtime.

ASSETS NEEDED

Everything below is what is missing. What already exists is listed first so the gap is visible against it.

Already have

- Plaza set: BG_Sky, BG_Clouds, MG_Church, MG_People, FG_Huts, Ground, TextureMap_Piyesta, Level2_CompletedLook.

- Items and UI: magicbrush.png, brushcontainer.png, emptyink.png, hiddenflower.png, banka.png, OBRAlogo.png.
- Character sheets: FEMALE, MALE (apo), LOLO1–LOLO5 (age progression), LOLOGHOST (spirit). Each with turnaround, walk cycle, run cycle, extra poses and a colour palette.
- Coverage note: the plaza and the cast are well covered. What is missing is the alley sequence, the church interior, and everything that has to move but was painted into a backdrop.

A. Environments and backgrounds

- Church interior (Scene 2): nave background, altar, candle rack, pews, window light. Nothing for this exists — MG_Church is a facade.
- Alley 1 (Problem 2): background, midground, foreground, ground variant. Dark, narrow, behind the plaza. Needs enough vertical space for five birds to circle in.
- Alley 2 (Problem 3): same layer set, plus bandaritas strung overhead within reach, plus a surface a ladder can land against.
- Dark / night palette variant of TextureMap_Piyesta for the two alleys — the current tileset is daytime fiesta.
- Bandaritas as a separate interactive layer, in four states: intact, tangled with birds, being cut, removed.
- BG_Clouds and FG_Huts, no-bandarita variants — required by the Problem 3 cut route.
- MG_People, no-dancers variant — required by Problem 1 Path B, since the dancers never return.
- House exterior door set: closed, lit from inside, keyhole close-up, open.
- House interior, small room, candle on a table (Problem 1 Path C).
- Parade float — flagged in the original doc. Needs to move, since it is one of the two hazards enforcing the small-animal restriction.

B. Characters

- Dancers: fiesta-costume sheet with a dance loop, scared / fleeing, and hand-over-candle. The costume is new work — the existing sheets are in everyday clothes. If the costume sits on the MALE / FEMALE rig, the flee can reuse the existing run cycle.
- Dancers must also come out of the MG_People composite, which is required anyway by the Path B disappearance.
- Priest: idle and talking only. Cheapest as an outfit reskin on the MALE rig rather than a new sheet.
- Birds × 5: perched, flying, circling, carrying a scrap, eating bread, tangled in the bandaritas, knocked down. The five do not need to be visually distinct, but they do need to be individually addressable so a partial Path C result reads correctly.
- Covered already: apo (MALE / FEMALE), lolo at five ages, lolo's spirit (LOLOGHOST). Crowd pedestrians are palette swaps of MALE / FEMALE using the palette row on each sheet.
- Extras row confirmed on all sheets: idle, look up, look down, wave, jump, cheer. Three poses this level needs are not in it.
 - LOLOGHOST — praying. Scene 2 is built on this beat and nothing in the existing set substitutes for it. One pose, possibly two frames of drift since he floats.

- LOLOGHOST — laughing. Cheer is arms-up celebration, which reads as encouragement, not mockery. Laughing fires on every restriction violation, so it is the most-seen pose in the level and worth authoring properly.
 - MALE / FEMALE — climb cycle for Problem 3 route 3A. Two to four frames on a ladder. Alternative: change the design so the player jumps to reach the bandaritas and reuse the existing jump pose, which costs no art but weakens “make ladders / climb something”.
- Everything else this level asks of the apo and the spirit is covered by turnaround, walk, run and the six extras.

C. Props and items

- Kandila: unlit inventory icon, lit, placed on the altar.
- Seven painting scraps cut from Level2_CompletedLook along torn edges — five carried by birds, two from the bandaritas.
- Crease overlay, transparent PNG sized to Level2_CompletedLook.
- Assembled painting frame for Scene 3.
- Small effects: breadcrumbs, cut-thread fall, scrap pickup, bird-downed puff.

D. UI

- Dance minigame: timing track, cue icons, hit / miss feedback, attempt counter (1 of 2), cleared panel, flower-withheld panel.
- Problem 2 Path C: aim and trajectory indicator, plus the 45–60 second timer readout and a birds-remaining count.
- Scrap counter (x of N).
- Checkpoint marker and respawn transition.
- Flight-limit warning band, drawn at the bandarita line in each scene.
- Banned-class feedback for the small-animal rule — the player needs to know why the drawing was refused, not just that it was.
- Scene 3 assembly UI: seven slots and snap feedback.
- Dialogue box frame plus portraits for lolo, apo, priest and a dancer.
- Redraw prompt for a rejected sketch — reuse the existing one.

E. Not art — drawn by the player

- snake, monkey, shark, frog, key, door, boomerang, ladder, stairs, scissors, bread. All eleven are in the 50-class vocabulary. No sprites, no new classes, nothing outstanding.

F. Audio

- Fiesta band loop (plaza), church ambience with reverb (Scene 2), alley ambience.
 - SFX: bird calls and wings, boomerang throw and hit, scissors snip, ladder climb, candle light, dance cue hit and miss, timer running out.
-

LEVEL FLOW CHART

None

```
%% OBRA - LEVEL 2: PISTA - level flow (revision 3)
%% Shape key (BPMN convention):
%%  ([ ])  start / end event
%%  { }    gateway - a player choice, or a branch on a result
%%  [ ]    task / action
%%  [/ /]  data object - a flag written to save state
%%  ((( ))) checkpoint
```

flowchart TD

```
S(["Start: enter Pista"]) --> G0{"Level 1 =<br/>Protector path?"}
G0 -->|Yes| D0[/ "CREASE = true"/]
G0 -->|No| D1[/ "CREASE = false"/]
D0 --> RST["Arm restrictions:<br/>flight capped at the bandarita line,<br/>no ant,
bee, butterfly, spider, scorpion, snail"]
D1 --> RST
RST --> CP1(((Checkpoint 1)))

subgraph SG1["PROBLEM 1 - get the KANDILA"]
    direction TB
    Q1{"Choose approach"}

    Q1 -->|"A. Ask the dancers"| A1["Dance minigame:<br/>time the drawing to the
steps"]
    A1 --> A2{"Cleared within<br/>2 attempts?"}
    A2 -->|Yes| A3["Kandila + flower"]
    A3 --> A4[/ "HAS_FLOWER = true<br/>secret ending stays open"/]
    A2 -->|No| A5["Kandila only.<br/>Dancers withhold the flower"]

    Q1 -->|"B. Scare the dancers"| B1["Draw snake / monkey / shark / frog"]
    B1 --> B2["Dancers flee and never return.<br/>Take the kandila"]
    B2 --> B3[/ "DANCERS_GONE = true<br/>use no-dancers MG_People from here"/]

    Q1 -->|"C. Find a candle"| C1["Search the houses,<br/>find a door lit from
inside"]
    C1 --> C2{"Made a key<br/>in Level 1?"}
    C2 -->|Yes| C3["Lolo: we have done this before"]
    C2 -->|No| C4["Lolo guides the player"]
    C3 --> C5["Draw the key, get inside,<br/>take the kandila"]
    C4 --> C5
end

CP1 --> Q1
A4 --> SC2
A5 --> SC2
B3 --> SC2
C5 --> SC2

SC2["SCENE 2 - church:<br/>place the kandila, lolo prays,<br/>the priest points to
the dark alleys"] --> CP2(((Checkpoint 2)))

subgraph SG2["PROBLEM 2 - Alley 1: 5 birds, 1 scrap each"]
    direction TB
    Q2{"Choose approach"}
```

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    Q2 -->|"A. Calm them"| E1["Draw bread, feed all 5.<br/>Lore: they used to feed
them"]
    E1 --> E2["Recover all 5 scraps"]
    E2 --> E3[/"BIRDS_IN_ALLEY2 = 0"/]

    Q2 -->|"B. Chase them"| E4["All 5 scatter and tangle<br/>in the bandaritas"]
    E4 --> E5[/"BIRDS_IN_ALLEY2 = 5"/]

    Q2 -->|"C. Hit them"| E6["45-60s timer:<br/>aim the boomerang at 5 birds"]
    E6 --> E7{"Timer expires"}
    E7 -->|"All 5 downed"| E2
    E7 -->|"N still airborne"| E8["Downed birds drop their scraps.<br/>Lolo: maybe
they flew nearby, come on"]
    E8 --> E9[/"BIRDS_IN_ALLEY2 = N"/]
end

CP2 --> Q2
E3 --> CP3(((Checkpoint 3)))
E5 --> CP3
E9 --> CP3

subgraph SG3["PROBLEM 3 - Alley 2: free choice, 2 options"]
    direction TB
    Q3{"Climb or cut?"}
    Q3 -->|"3A. Climb"| F1["Draw a ladder or stairs,<br/>reach the bandaritas"]
    Q3 -->|"3B. Cut"| F2["Draw scissors,<br/>cut the bandaritas down"]
    F2 --> F3[/"BANDARITAS_CUT = true<br/>no bandaritas in later scenes<br/>flight
ceiling lifts"/]
    F1 --> F4["Recover the 2 bandarita scraps,<br/>plus any carried by the tangled
birds"]
    F3 --> F4
end

CP3 --> Q3
F4 --> SC3

SC3["SCENE 3 - assemble 7 scraps.<br/>Crease shown if CREASE = true"] -->
FIN(["Unlock the next level: Dagat"])

subgraph SGR["Restriction handler - runs for the whole level"]
    direction TB
    V1{"Flew above the bandarita line,<br/>or spawned a banned small
animal?<br/>(flight rule is off once BANDARITAS_CUT)"}
    V1 -->|Yes| V2["Lolo laughs at the apo.<br/>Return to the nearest checkpoint
behind them.<br/>Inventory and flags are kept, only position resets."]
end

```

